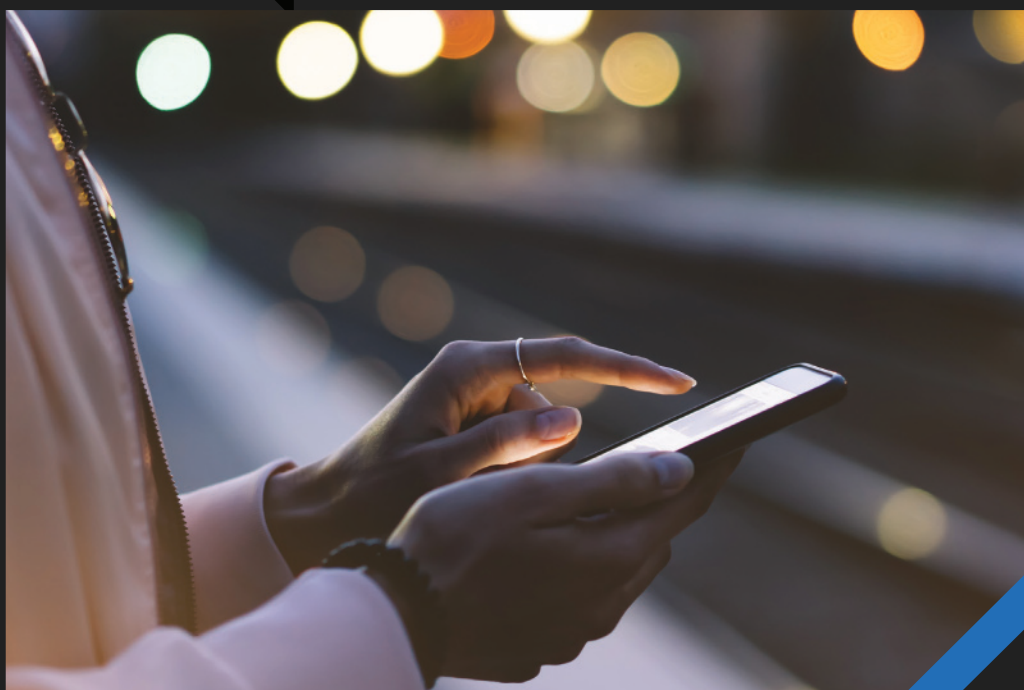


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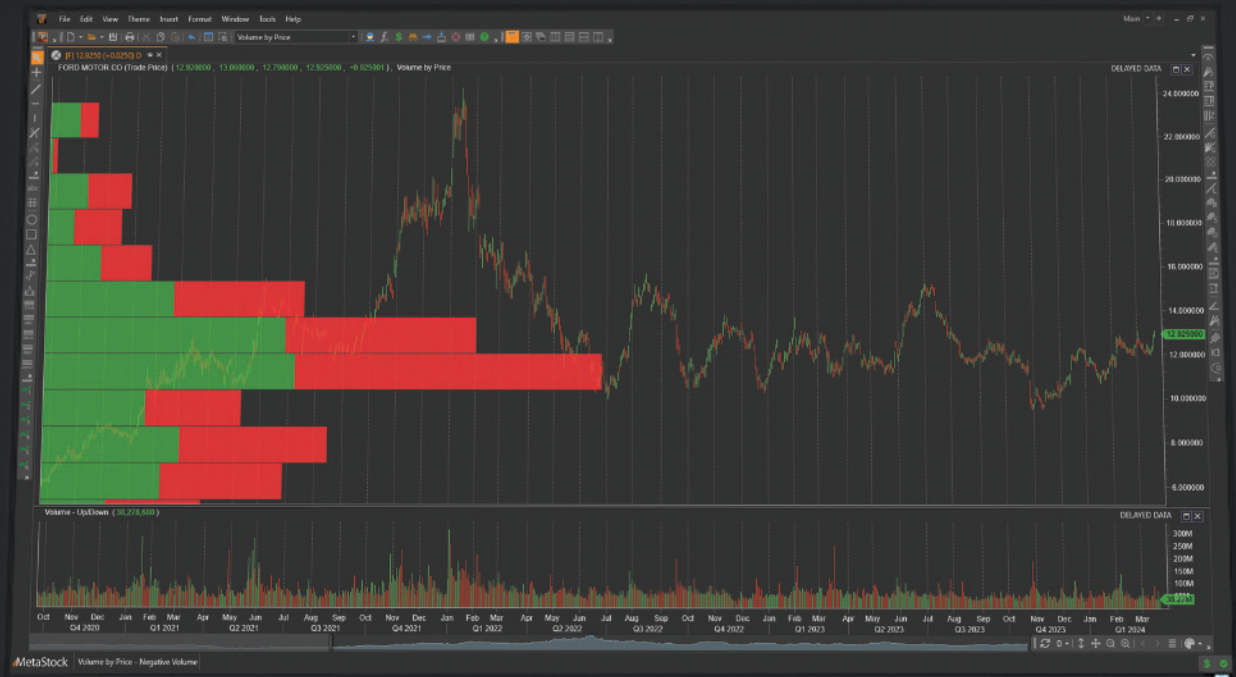
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Debugging Tips

Plotting With Strategies

Here are a couple of quick tips to help you better visualize your strategies as you work.

by John F. Ehlers



I want to share a really cool function that I recently rediscovered.

I was adding a following stop (trailing stop) to one of my strategies, and it was not behaving as I expected. It would be so easy to debug if I could only visualize what was going on. But TradeStation and MultiCharts do not allow plotting of an indicator within a strategy. I could write a parallel following stop indicator that simulates the trade event, but that seems like too much work when I already had the trade event and the stop code in the strategy. I used to have a function that plots an indicator within a strategy, but that function had been lost. So I searched the internet. I found a new version of the function, called **_TLPlotFast**, at <https://hightick.com>. The function code is downloadable from that website. The function is also thoroughly described at that website, so I won't waste space describing it here. It is a neat tool in your toolbox to help debug a strategy or just to visualize what is going on with the strategy code.

ANOTHER TIP FOR EASYLANGUAGE

On another note, there are two little-known keywords in EasyLanguage that provide useful information that you can plot in a subgraph below a chart containing a strategy. Here is the complete code for the indicator because there are no variables to declare:

```
Plot1(I_ClosedEquity);
Plot2(I_OpenEquity);
```

This indicator plots the equity curve of your strategy in time sync with the price bars. That is helpful in providing the performance of your strategy at a glance. It is also a little fascinating to watch your runup and drawdown unfold in real time.

*John Ehlers is a retired electrical engineer and a retired technical analyst, specializing in the application of DSP (digital signal processing) to trading. For more information, see www.mesasoftware.com. His new book, *Cybernetic Trading Indicators*, is now available through Amazon.com.*

‡TradeStation
‡<https://hightick.com>

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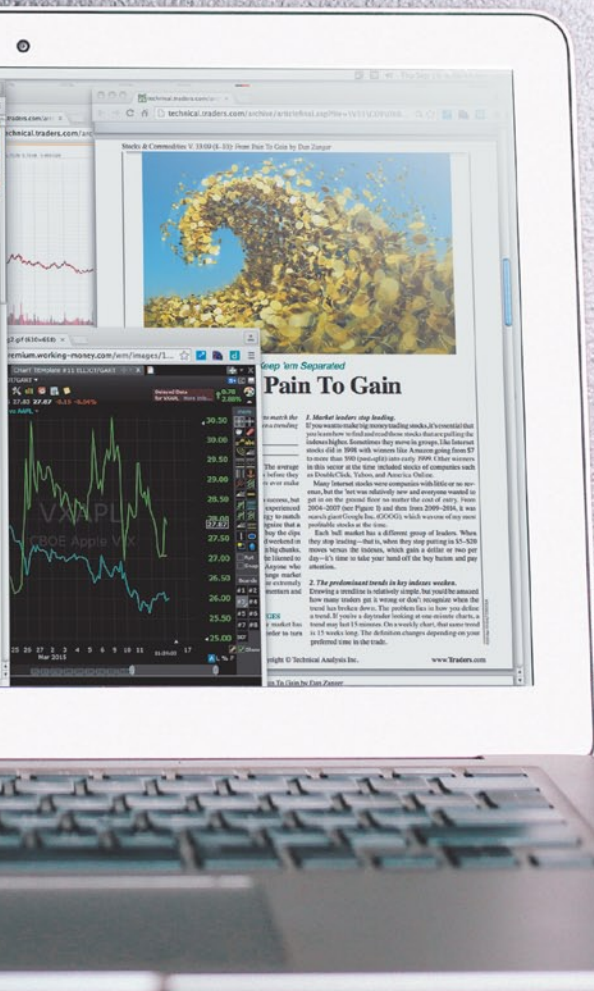
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